

Data Analytics will be the Next Big Thing for Engineers

There is a growing demand for engineers in the data analytics (DA) field, with some companies particularly looking for electronics engineers with a penchant for programming and mathematics. Of course, jobs in DA pay really well too! So let us find out the skills, salary and what lies ahead for a career in DA

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Today, most of the jobs available in data analytics (DA) are for computer science graduates, but there are some companies that particularly look for electronics engineers. An engineering degree with a knack for programming, statistics and mathematics is the latest choice for employers hiring in the DA domain.

Anand Sankaran, senior principal architect, Verizon Data Services, India informs that many universities in the US, Europe and India have started specialised courses both at graduate and undergraduate levels to cater to the increasing demand for DA professionals.

The exponential growth in DA is catalysed by an unprecedented availability of data, thanks to a steep fall of storage cost and the ubiquitous need to extract valuable insights from a volume of data to solve business problems. He says, "A recent article in the Harvard Business Review predicts

that DA will be one of the coolest and the fastest growing career paths in the coming decade, and we have seen studies that highlight a shortfall of qualified candidates to meet the job requirements in this space."

Why engineers

Basically, engineers have a good blend of learning in technology, mathematics and data science. Sudeshna Datta, EVP and co-founder, Absolutdata says, "Engineers have been critical to the growth of the analytics market in India and are very apt to make a career in DA. To add, now there are institutions who help engineers learn the basics of machine learning and big data in the curriculum."

However, Ashish Soni, chief analytics officer, Costarch believes that engineering graduates fit into the area of DA only if they have an inclination towards number crunching. Their quantitative and computer skills give them the competitive edge

that graduates from other streams do not have. In short, he says, "If an engineering graduate is looking for a career in data analytics, he/she should focus on improving his/her numerical computation skills, learn some numerical programming language and explore the area of statistics."

Engineering graduates with a good knowledge of programming and business can have a well-defined career path in this sector. Harvard Business School predicts that there is a serious dearth of data scientists in the US alone. "With open data movements gathering steam across the world, scope for engineering graduates to

Four Major Categories Hiring Data Analysts

1. IT companies
2. KPOs (knowledge process outsourcing)
3. Captive analytics units
4. Niche analytics firms

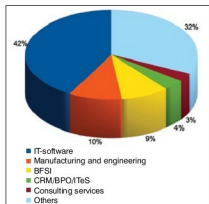


Fig. 1: Top five industries for data analytics (Data courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

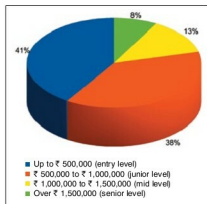


Fig. 2: Salary breakup of data analysts (Data courtesy: TimesJobs.com)

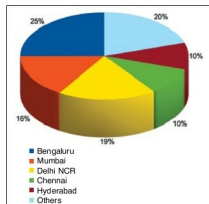


Fig. 3: Top five locations for data analytics (Data courtesy: TimesJobs.com)